

Weekly Lesson-Plan Packet

Knights of The Kingdom of Christ Order

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Instructor Guidance Each weekly session should include four subjects, one review exercise, one discussion period, one written or oral assessment, and one small practical assignment. Schoolmasters should adapt the tone and workload to age and rank.

Squire School Detailed Weekly Plans

Week 1 — Origins and Virtues Lesson 1: Explain the First Crusade in age-appropriate terms and why the Holy Land mattered to medieval Christians. Lesson 2: Explain why pilgrims traveled to Jerusalem and what dangers they faced. Lesson 3: Explain why an order to protect pilgrims was formed. Lesson 4: Introduce the virtues of honesty, courage, obedience, charity, and reverence. Activity: Draw a simple map of Europe and the Holy Land. Assessment: Five-question oral check. Homework: Memorize the dates 1095 to 1099 and the name Hugh de Payns.

Week 2 — Founding People and Places Lesson 1: Hugh de Payns and the first companions. Lesson 2: King Baldwin II and the kingdom of Jerusalem. Lesson 3: The Temple Mount and the early headquarters. Lesson 4: Fact versus legend. Activity: Timeline strip and matching names to roles. Assessment: Short written summary of why the order began. Homework: Define founder, pilgrim, headquarters, and legend.

Week 3 — Approval and Mission Lesson 1: The Council of Troyes. Lesson 2: Bernard of Clairvaux and support for the order. Lesson 3: What makes a religious order different from an ordinary army. Lesson 4: Timeline review from 1095 to 1139. Activity: Recitation circle. Assessment: Ten-question multiple choice quiz. Homework: Read a short handout on papal support.

Week 4 — Structure and Daily Life Lesson 1: Knight, Sergeant, and Chaplain classes. Lesson 2: Grand Master, Seneschal, Marshal, and Preceptor. Lesson 3: Clothing, symbols, mantles, and discipline. Lesson 4: Service before self. Activity: Role-card matching game. Assessment: Identify classes and offices from memory. Homework: One-paragraph reflection on discipline.

Week 5 — Life of the Order Lesson 1: Castles, roads, and pilgrim protection. Lesson 2: Prayer, worship, and routine life. Lesson 3: Charity and almsgiving. Lesson 4: Personal rule of conduct. Activity: Draft a simple personal rule of conduct. Assessment: Participation and conduct review. Homework: Service task at home or church with adult signoff.

Week 6 — Power and Crisis Lesson 1: Why the Templars became powerful. Lesson 2: Why wealth and influence can create enemies. Lesson 3: The fall of Acre in 1291. Lesson 4: Mission drift and why orders must remember their purpose. Activity: Cause-and-effect chart. Assessment: Explain in your own words why Acre mattered.

Homework: Prepare one question for class discussion.

Week 7 — Suppression and Courage Lesson 1: Philip IV and the 1307 arrests. Lesson 2: Pope Clement V and suppression. Lesson 3: Jacques de Molay and the end of the order. Lesson 4: Justice, false accusation, courage, and endurance. Activity: Guided discussion with age-appropriate moderation. Assessment: Short paragraph on courage. Homework: Review full timeline.

Week 8 — Review and Board Preparation Lesson 1: Complete timeline review. Lesson 2: Map review and figure identification. Lesson 3: Service project presentation. Lesson 4: Promotion board expectations. Activity: Oral recitation and group review. Assessment: Final written and oral review. Homework: None; prepare for board.

Adult Member School Detailed Weekly Plans

Week 1 — The World Before the Order Lesson 1: First Crusade and Crusader states. Lesson 2: Pilgrim vulnerability and frontier insecurity. Lesson 3: Original mission of the order. Lesson 4: Dangers of simplistic crusader romanticism. Activity: Source comparison between short summaries. Assessment: One-page reflection. Homework: Read introductory Templar overview.

Week 2 — Foundation in Jerusalem Lesson 1: Hugh de Payns and early companions. Lesson 2: Baldwin II and the political setting. Lesson 3: Temple Mount headquarters and symbolism. Lesson 4: Founding summary workshop. Activity: Build a foundational timeline. Assessment: One-page founding summary. Homework: Prepare notes on why the order gained support.

Week 3 — Approval and Privilege Lesson 1: Council of Troyes. Lesson 2: Bernard of Clairvaux and the idea of a new knighthood. Lesson 3: Omne Datum Optimum and papal privilege. Lesson 4: Obedience, autonomy, and accountability. Activity: Debate on whether privileges strengthen or weaken accountability. Assessment: Fifteen-question quiz. Homework: Write definitions of papal bull, autonomy, and sanction.

Week 4 — Organization and Identity Lesson 1: Grand Master, Seneschal, Marshal, Preceptor, Treasurer, Draper, Prior, Turcopolier. Lesson 2: Knight, Sergeant, and Chaplain classes. Lesson 3: Discipline and organizational culture. Lesson 4: Comparison exercise between the historical order and a modern nonprofit order. Activity: Structure chart creation. Assessment: Explain how offices differ from member classes. Homework: Read on hierarchy and class structure.

Week 5 — Height of Influence Lesson 1: Warfare and logistics in historical context. Lesson 2: Wealth, land, and trans-European networks. Lesson 3: Admiration and resentment. Lesson 4: Institutional risk when success grows. Activity: Case-study analysis. Assessment: Short essay on wealth and vulnerability. Homework: Prepare one discussion point on mission drift.

Week 6 — Decline of Purpose Lesson 1: Acre and the end of the Holy Land stronghold. Lesson 2: Loss of original strategic mission. Lesson 3: Philip IV's motives. Lesson 4: Why powerful semi-autonomous bodies become political targets. Activity: Cause ranking chart. Assessment: Group discussion scored by rubric.

Homework: Read trial and suppression summary.

Week 7 — Trial and Suppression Lesson 1: Arrests in 1307. Lesson 2: Clement V and the Council of Vienne. Lesson 3: Jacques de Molay and the final executions. Lesson 4: Torture, confession, propaganda, and source criticism. Activity: Evaluate a claim using source questions: who wrote it, when, why. Assessment: Written response on the fairness of the trials. Homework: Study myth versus history examples.

Week 8 — Legacy, Myth, and Modern Use Lesson 1: Templar myths after 1312. Lesson 2: Revivalist claims and popular legends. Lesson 3: What Knights of The Kingdom of Christ Order may responsibly preserve. Lesson 4: Final oral board and written exam. Activity: Closing seminar and question period. Assessment: Final exam plus oral board. Homework: Begin rank-up reading list.

Suggested Teaching Methods Use map work, oral recitation, question circles, reading journals, short papers, chapter service reports, timeline drills, role charts, and source-comparison exercises. Avoid teaching legend as fact. Keep difficult materials age-appropriate for squires.